



FREE GUIDE · FOR CLOSED-DOOR & LTC PHARMACIES

The Closed-Door Pharmacy's Guide to Compliant Disposal.

Resident returns, blister packs, and controls —
audit-ready destruction for LTC.

DEA-REGISTERED

EPA-COMPLIANT

NO CONTRACT

CERTIFICATE OF DESTRUCTION

Compliance, made simple.

LTC returns, done by the book.

Closed-door and institutional pharmacies serve long-term care — which means resident medication returns, blister-pack and unit-dose waste, and controlled substances with strict audit requirements. The volume of returns from facilities makes systematic, documented destruction essential. This guide covers every stream.

The good news

We handle LTC resident returns and pharmacy waste — controlled and non-controlled — with reverse distribution for credit, non-retrievable destruction, Form 222/41, and audit-ready Certificates of Destruction. No contract.

AT A GLANCE

Who regulates what.

Agency	What it covers in your practice
OSHA	Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — sharps handling, containers, and annual staff training.
EPA	RCRA — hazardous pharmaceutical waste identification, segregation, and destruction.
DEA	Controlled substances — non-retrievable destruction and DEA Form 41 documentation.
DOT	Safe shipping of regulated medical and pharmaceutical waste in transit.
State	Health-department and environmental rules that vary by state.

THE STREAMS

Every stream, in depth.

Below is each regulated stream your practice produces — what belongs in it, what does not, the rule behind it, how to dispose of it, and a tip to stay clean.

WASTE STREAM 01

Controlled substances

Resident controlled-substance returns from LTC facilities — the stream with the strictest audit trail.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired / unused Schedule II–V stock
- Returns of controls (per program)
- Partial & wasted doses

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-controlled meds (pharmaceutical kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · DEA — Form 222 for Schedule II transfers, Form 41 for surrendered controls, and non-retrievable destruction with records.

DISPOSE WITH · Controlled-substance mail-back / reverse distribution, to DEA standards.

Tip

We're a DEA-registered reverse distributor — the credential that makes taking back your controls legal.

WASTE STREAM 02

Pharmaceutical waste (non-hazardous)

Blister-pack, unit-dose, and resident medication returns (non-controlled, non-hazardous).

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired non-controlled, non-hazardous Rx
- OTC & compounded non-haz product
- Samples

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Controlled substances
- RCRA-hazardous drugs
- Sharps

THE RULE · Do not drain-dispose; destroy with documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Pharmaceutical waste mail-back kit.

Tip

Segregate hazardous and controlled drugs first — everything else routes here.

WASTE STREAM 03

Reverse distribution & returns

Returnable expired and unused stock, recovered for credit.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired / unused returnable Rx
- Overstock & discontinued inventory
- Manufacturer recalls
- Brand & generic stock

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Opened / adulterated product (destroy only)
- Patient-owned meds
- Sharps

THE RULE · Returnable items are processed for manufacturer credit; non-returnable items are rendered non-retrievable with documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Pharmaceutical reverse distribution — credit recovered, the rest destroyed.

Tip

Items you'd have thrown away may still be credit-eligible — don't pre-sort them into the trash.

WASTE STREAM 04

RCRA-hazardous drugs

P/U-listed and characteristic hazardous drugs from returns.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- P-listed (warfarin $\geq 0.3\%$, nicotine, epinephrine)
- U-listed drugs
- Characteristic waste (ignitable, toxic)
- Certain chemotherapy agents

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-hazardous pharmaceuticals
- Controlled substances (own path)

THE RULE · EPA RCRA — identify P/U-listed and characteristic drugs, segregate, and destroy to EPA standards; know your generator status.

DISPOSE WITH · RCRA-hazardous mail-back kit.

Tip

Nicotine and epinephrine are P-listed — easy to miss and a common citation.

WASTE STREAM 05

Sharps

From any facility-administered injectables you handle.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Immunization needles & syringes
- Lancets
- Point-of-care testing sharps

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-sharp meds
- Bloody gauze (biohazard)

THE RULE · OSHA — FDA-cleared, puncture-resistant containers; annual training if staff are exposed.

DISPOSE WITH · Sharps mail-back kit.

Tip

Immunizing pharmacies generate more sharps than they expect — size accordingly.

YOUR CHECKLIST

The closed-door pharmacy compliance checklist.

- ☐ Resident controlled-substance returns logged, non-retrievable, with Form 41 and chain-of-custody.
- ☐ Blister-pack and unit-dose returns destroyed with documentation.
- ☐ Returnable stock recovered for credit via reverse distribution.
- ☐ Hazardous drugs from returns segregated and destroyed to EPA standards.
- ☐ Certificates of Destruction and return records retained per your state's rules.

QUESTIONS CLOSED-DOOR PHARMACIES ASK

Your closed-door pharmacy questions, answered.

How do we handle controlled-substance returns from LTC facilities?

Through DEA-registered reverse distribution — logged, rendered non-retrievable, with Form 41 and full chain-of-custody documentation.

What about blister packs and unit-dose returns?

Non-controlled, non-hazardous returns are destroyed as pharmaceutical waste with documentation; returnable stock is recovered for credit.

Do you provide audit-ready records?

Yes — Certificates of Destruction and return documentation for every batch.

Do we need a contract?

No — no contract, no minimums.

THE EASY WAY

Handle it with mail-back.

Easy Rx Cycle handles pharmacy waste by prepaid mail-back or scheduled pickup for higher volume. Returnable Rx is processed for manufacturer credit; controlled and non-controlled waste is destroyed non-retrievable with a Certificate of Destruction. Form 222/41 handled. No contract.

QUICK REFERENCE · WHICH KIT FOR WHICH STREAM

Waste stream	The right path
Resident controlled returns	Controlled destruction (Form 41, chain-of-custody)
Blister-pack / unit-dose returns	Pharmaceutical waste kit
Returnable stock	Reverse distribution (credit)
Hazardous drugs	RCRA-hazardous mail-back kit
Sharps	Sharps mail-back kit

Prefer pickup, or higher volume?

LTC return volume usually favors scheduled pickup with centralized records over mail-back. We'll size it — get a quote at easyrxcycle.com/get-a-quote or call 501-904-2929.

WHY CLOSED-DOOR PHARMACIES CHOOSE EASY RX CYCLE

- No contract, no minimums — buy as you need
- Flat-rate pricing — no fuel or hidden surcharges
- One vendor for every stream you generate
- DEA-registered, EPA- & OSHA-aligned destruction
- A Certificate of Destruction on every single order



Ready to simplify your closed-door pharmacy waste?

Shop mail-back kits with prices, or get a custom quote for pickup and higher volume. No contract, cancel anytime.

501-904-2929 · sales@easyrxcycle.com · easyrxcycle.com/shop